

Synthetic Arguments

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Collective Action

Development of Democracy

- Democracy as *contestation*: there exists broad inclusion and a legitimate opposition with a legitimate chance of gaining power
 - Dahl 1972: Democratization and development of the opposition are separate. Two dimensions: public contestation within politics, and the right to participate within politics. High contestation and high inclusiveness leads to polyarchy; other combinations are lesser
 - Double-transition rule: a nation is considered a developed democracy when rule transitions $A \rightarrow B \rightarrow A$
 - Dahl 1972: in the absence of any conflict, it is difficult to retain legitimate competition
- Expansion of the franchise:
 - Acemoglu & Robinson 2000 – the west extended the franchise as a credible commitment mechanism to “buy off” commoners
 - North & Weingast 1989 – expansion of property rights in 18th century England as a means of commitment against exploitation and to secure public investment / credit
 - Dahl 1972: three paths to polyarchy, (1) liberalization before inclusiveness, (2) inclusiveness before liberalization, (3) sudden shock (often unstable). Central question: do you make a hegemonic democracy first, or do you expand inclusion but retain authoritarianism under that broader franchise? Less common on the second one
- Expansion of the franchise – intentionally or unintentionally – requires additional institutional development:
 - Dahl 1972: Candidates and parties change as the franchise expands, in an effort to better achieve their electoral goals. Often results in new parties or party change (see Muller 1997 for a more comprehensive discussion of parties changing)

Historical Prerequisites for Democracy

- How agrarian classes developed:
 - Dahl 1972: Farming societies differentiated into peasantry (hegemony) or free farmers (polyarchy)

Nation-building & Nationality

- Four primary factors in whether an individual adopts new political beliefs: exposure, prestige, consistency w/ beliefs, consistency w/ experience **CITE**

Regime Transitions

Backsliding/Populism

International Influences

- Dahl 1972: Foreign influences can directly impose institutions, affect beliefs, or affect decision sets
- Gourevitch 1978: foreign politics have significant impacts on domestic structures BEYOND just the invasion effect

Party Politics

- Parties develop as coordination mechanisms to facilitate generally-common individual behaviors into tangible political action
- Cox 1997: The number of relevant parties or candidates we should expect is a function of both the number of relevant cleavages seeking representation and the permissiveness of electoral institutions to allow for such representation. Should expect $M + 1$ relevant competitors where M is district magnitude / number of seats available; Duverger is just this with $M = 1$
 - See Posner 2004 for why some cleavages are politically salient but others are not
 - See Fearon & Laitin 2003 for why some cleavages result in violence/instability but others do not

Methodological Reasoning

Empirical Logic & Evaluation

Rationality & Limits

General thoughts:

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Specific examples:

- Cox 1997: much of electoral politics happens outside of equilibrium
- Lijphart 1999: (my critique) characterizes a great deal of out-of-equilibrium behavior rather than ultimately proved short lived and ineffective

Positive Theory

Foundations of Institutions

Legislative Principal/Agents

- Cartel theory: parties are weak but legislators are strong; parties effectively cannot control their members (at least in US congress) and so instead must resort to influence and responsiveness
- Legislators face an inherent incentive to prioritize their own voters, but this can be counterproductive for their party – subsequently, a foundational tension exists between legislators and their party leaders about whether to vote in line or pursue individual goals:
 - Diermeier & Vlaicu 2011: collective action problem where legislator can extract personal rents at the expense of party unity
 - Jones & Hwang 2005: Cartel theory seems to occur in Argentina
 - Kats & Mair 1995: Cartel theory; mass party is a single point in party development and cartels create a near-total overlap between the party and the state
 - Crisp et al 2004: Legislators decide whether to focus on local or national issues
 - Carey & Shugart 1995: When voters decide to prioritize personal versus party reputation; how this might change across voting systems (big note here: closed list is hard-for-party)
 - Cox 1987: How this power cessation to the party occurred (by means of solving an information problem)
- Legislators have multiple principals to whom they are agents (Carey 2009) – the more agents there are, and the more authority they have, and the more their goals conflict, the less effective we should expect legislative outcomes to be.
 - Tsebelis 1999: the more veto players, the less effective we should expect the legislature to be – laws passed will be less significant
- For legislatures as principals, see Huber & Shipan 2002

Legislative Accountability & Elections

- Cox 1997: Elections are market activities with a balanced supply and demand of candidates ($M+1$ rule) BUT can be broken by specifically ethnic or geographic parties, etc. (like SNP)
 - Gibbard-Satterthwaite impossibility: either dictatorship, non-universality, not-strategy-proof, or indecisive
 - Arrow impossibility: either dictatorship, or IIA, or non-pareto
- Cox 1997: Three fundamental translations: social cleavages into partisan preferences, partisan preferences into votes, votes into seats

Majoritarian vs. Proportionalism

- Boix 1999: ruling parties can use the transition between majoritarianism and PR to maintain some exclusivity (even if possibly conceding contestation)

Authoritarian Politics

- Repression is costly (Dahl 1972) and accordingly regimes without significant resources may just be more likely to tolerate an active opposition; conversely, if the state is highly endowed, this can raise the stakes of holding office and become a broader issue [cite this specifically? Svolik 2012?](#)
 - Broad-scale oppression does not happen in polyarchies (Dahl 1972) – low barriers to contestation protect inclusivity for marginalized groups and preemptively dissuades additional violence by the state

Institutional Endogeneity

- Electoral institutions are created by political actors with incentives to maximize their chances of achieving, holding, and executing power (Boix 1999, Lijphart 1991 is a bit softer)
- The choice of electoral institutions tangibly impacts policy outcomes – very similar to above point, with Cox’s applied translations (social cleavages → partisan preferences → votes → seats) – see Cox 1997
- An abundance of resources makes holding power more valuable; Dahl 1972: those with the means to do so will attempt to bend political systems in their favor, but the distribution of those means itself is endogenous. (Also tied to inequality, which can arise in more developed economies)

Presidential vs Parliamentary

Bureaucracy

Other assorted factors (and where to find them)

- Trust: Dahl 1972, mechanized through commitment devices by A&R, N&W, and within authoritarian states by Gandhi & Przeworski 2007